

PROJECT REPORT--- SCHEDULED PHONE USAGE

PROBLEM CHOSEN:

The problem I decided to work on is something very common and relatable, especially among students - using our mobile phones way more than we should. I didn't pick this randomly. It's something I am personally struggling with too.

Many times, I sit down to study or do anything productive, but then I just pick up my phone for no strong reason. Maybe to check one message or just open an app for a minute. But that "one minute" usually turns into much more. Even during exams, with limited time to finish revising my syllabus, I realized that I was using my mobile more than not.

I realized that this is not just my problem, a lot of people around me do the exact same thing. So instead of choosing something complicated or a theoretical problem, I thought it would be a better idea to work on something real and relatable.

WHY THIS PROBLEM MATTERS?

Initially, it doesn't seem like a big problem. I mean, the use of a phone is not a big deal, is it? However, the problem lies in the fact that we do it so often without even thinking about how much time it is wasting of ours.

However, when such things happen again and again, it disrupts the concentration. Even if you want to do something, you won't be able to focus on it as you get distracted. The worst part is, most of the time, you won't even be able to see the amount of time you are wasting.

If you see it over a few days, you won't think it is a big deal. However, over a longer period of time, it can have a big impact. This is the reason why I thought this problem is actually big, though it might seem small.

MY APPROACH TO SOLVING IT:

I knew from the beginning that I did not want to make it too complex or unrealistic. Honestly, if a solution is too strict or idealistic, people would not use it.

I made it simple. The idea was to control phone use, not stop it completely. Stopping it completely is not possible.

What I did was introduce a scheduled system. It would ask for a start time and an end time. That would be the “allowed” time for phone use. After that, the program would check the time from the system.

If the time is within the allowed range, it would display a positive message saying that you can use your phone. If not, it would display a negative message saying “not allowed,” “stay focused,” etc.

It is actually a very simple program, but the idea behind it is that a person would stop and think when a small interruption happens. That stop might actually be enough to not cause any unnecessary distraction.

KEY DECISIONS I MADE:

During the development of the project, I had to make some decisions, though small.

The first decision I had to make for the development of the project is to make it simple and basic. I have not used any library or feature of the Python program, however advanced it may be, as I am also a beginner. I have only used the basic concepts of the Python programming language and have kept it as simple and as easy to understand as possible for someone like me.

The next decision I had to make for the development of the project is to make it such that it is not too strict or unrealistic. I could have also attempted to make it such that it does not allow the user to make use of it in the first place. However, I felt it was not practical enough, as people find ways to come out of such situations or simply choose to ignore them. I attempted to make it a bit more of a reminder.

The next decision I had to make for the development of the project is to make it more logical. I have not added any GUI and have not used any such feature as I wanted to ensure the concept was working properly.

The next decision I had to make for the development of the project is to make it more flexible, keeping in mind the fact that the user could put in different time slots every time they wanted to use the program.

CHALLENGES I FACED:

Some problems that came when working on this project:

The first challenge was how to compare time properly. This might sound easy, but at first, I was a little confused on how to check whether the current time was between the start time and the end time properly. It took me quite a few attempts before I got it right.

The second challenge was not making the project complicated. At one point, I thought of adding some features to this project, but then it became complicated. Therefore, I had to take a step back and remember to keep it simple and readable.

In addition, making the code look clean and easy to read was a challenge. It was not looking right if the code was messy and confusing.

WHAT I LEARNED:

This project has helped me in a number of ways:

From a coding perspective:

I became comfortable with:

- Using if-else statements properly

- Getting input from the user

- Thinking logically

But more than that, I realized that sometimes, to solve problems in real life, one does not need complicated solutions. In many instances, even a small idea or approach can go a VERY long way.

I also realized that understanding the problem is more important than coding. If one has thought the problem through properly, then the coding part becomes easy.

And lastly, it made me more aware of my own phone use habits, which was not expected at first.

CONCLUSION

Therefore, to sum up this project, I would say that while it might look easy at first glance, for me as a person, this project turned out to be much more meaningful than I thought at first. I mean, when I started working on this project, I thought of it as a small coding problem to be solved as part of the course I am taking. Yet, while working on this problem, I slowly came to understand that this problem is actually connected to a lot of things in real life, especially when we think of how we spend our time in real life.

Phone usage is something we all need to deal with at certain times of our lives, and most of the time we don't even think of it as something to be worried about. We simply keep checking our phones over and over again without thinking much about the issue at hand. While working on this project, I did not solve this problem as such, yet I tried to approach this problem in a certain manner. Rather than imposing certain constraints or solutions to the problem at hand, I simply tried to create a small system to remind you to be more careful.

What I liked most about this project is the fact that while this is not a complicated project to be done as such, it is sensible and makes sense as well. It simply shows you that while you might not need to know much coding to be able to make a small difference in life, you can always use the knowledge you already have to make something sensible of it.

And also, I suppose, while I was making this, I sort of became more aware of my own habits too. Like, I started becoming more aware of how often I'm reaching for my phone without any real reason. So, in a way, the project didn't just stay on the screen, it actually made me think a bit about my daily routine.

Now, I suppose, there's a lot that can be improved. It's very basic right now, but it could be improved if I added more features or made it more interactive. I suppose, though, for right now, it does serve its purpose.

Ultimately, I suppose, this project isn't really about how advanced it is, but more about the thought behind it. Maybe it'll make someone think for a second before using their phone, and I suppose, in a way, that's enough for me to be able to say this was all worth it.